

Medicus Suite — setup guide for Pete

Local install on each PC. Shared folder is only the drop-box. Microsoft Edge (NHS default). One practice packager + first end-user PC. September 2026.

1. What this solves

Running Suite from the shared drive is slow, and staff hate clicking Reload unpacked after every update. The fix: each PC keeps a **copy on its own disk**. You drop a new version in the shared folder. A small Windows task copies it across at logon. Suite then shows **Suite files updated — Reload**. The extension never copies files itself and never installs itself from the share.

2. Pete — publish a new Suite version

Use your real share path everywhere you see `S:\MedicusSuite` (or `\\Server\MedicusSuite`). Create `incoming` and `current` once. Always publish into `current` — never a folder named after the version.

1. Unpack the new zip into `S:\MedicusSuite\incoming`. You should see `manifest.json` in that folder, not inside another folder.
2. Copy `tools\windows\suite-release.example.json` from the zip to `S:\MedicusSuite\incoming\suite-release.json`.
3. Open `suite-release.json` in Notepad. Set `"version"` to the same number as in `manifest.json` (for example `3.261.16`). Set `"ready"` to `false` while you are still copying. Leave `"allowDowngrade"` as `false`.
4. When every file is in place, change `"ready"` to `true` and save.
5. Swap the folders: rename `current` to `current-old`, rename `incoming` to `current`, then make a new empty `incoming` for next time. Delete `current-old` when you are happy.
6. Do **not** ask anyone to Load unpacked from the share.

3. First PC — one-time setup

Put the two scripts from the zip on the share (for example `S:\MedicusSuite\tools\windows\`). PowerShell is fine. Do this on one machine first and check it works before rolling out.

1. Close Edge (and Chrome if it is open) on this PC.
2. Right-click Start → Windows PowerShell. Type these two lines (change the share path if needed) and press Enter after each. That creates a logon task named **MedicusSuite-LocalSync**.

```
cd S:\MedicusSuite\tools\windows
powershell -NoProfile -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\Register-SyncTask.ps1 -Reference "S:\MedicusSuite\current"
```

3. In the same window, run the copy once now so the local folder exists before you open Edge. You want `%LOCALAPPDATA%\MedicusSuite\extension` containing `manifest.json`.

```
powershell -NoProfile -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\Sync-MedicusSuite.ps1 -Reference "S:\MedicusSuite\current"
```

4. Open **Edge**. Type `edge://extensions` in the address bar and press Enter.
5. Turn on **Developer mode** (top right). Click **Load unpacked**. In File Explorer's address bar paste `%LOCALAPPDATA%\MedicusSuite\extension`, then Select Folder.
6. On the Suite card click **Details**. *Source / Loaded from* must be that local path — not a path starting with `\\` and not `S:\`.
7. Pin the Suite icon. Open Options once. Repeat steps 1–6 on each other PC. Never Load unpacked from a different folder later — that makes Suite forget its settings.

4. What users see after you publish

Next logon (Edge closed) the PC copies the new files. Users see **Suite files updated — Reload** in Options and at the top of the side panel. They click **Reload**. They do not open `edge://extensions` and they do not download a GitHub zip.

5. If it does not copy or does not update

What you see	What to do
Share is down / laptop at home	Leave it. The last local copy keeps working. The task tries again next logon.
Edge (or Chrome) is still open	The copy will not replace the live folder (avoids a half-updated Suite). Close the browser and run the Sync script again, or wait for the next logon.
<code>ready</code> is still <code>false</code>	You have not finished publishing. PCs will not copy. Set it to <code>true</code> and swap to <code>current</code> .
Details shows the share, not the local folder	This PC is on the old slow setup. Remove the extension and Load unpacked again from <code>%LOCALAPPDATA%\MedicusSuite\extension</code> .
No Reload banner	Same version already, share down, Edge was open at logon, or <code>ready</code> was false. Check the local <code>manifest.json</code> version against yours.
Suite “forgot” everyone	Someone loaded a different folder. Load unpacked from the original local path again.

6. What this is not

Practice Profile is settings, not a new Suite version.

Options → Backup & Restore → Practice Profile pushes practice rules and defaults. It does not copy extension files. A new zip is bits: you publish to the share, Windows copies, users click Reload. Do not mix the two. Do not use the GitHub “View release” banner for practice machines.